

## **Brightwater Health - HIPAA compliance audit summary, March 2026**

Scope: Project Lodestar and the enterprise master patient index. The audit reviewed access controls, encryption, retention, and the manual review workflow for proposed record merges.

Lodestar satisfied the access control and encryption requirements. The Parquet snapshot retention finding from the February 2026 security review was remediated on 20 February 2026.

New observation: manual review decisions did not require a second reviewer for merges involving minors. Brightwater has since introduced dual review for every proposed merge involving a patient under 18.

## **Outcome metrics**

After six months of operation, the duplicate patient record rate fell from 8.1 percent to 2.3 percent. The false merge rate measured in the Q1 2026 audit sample was 0.04 percent.

The auditors recommend extending the same record linkage approach to the provider directory in 2027.